

THE GLAMSQUAD SALON

Project Overview & Business Problem

Profitability & Operational Analytics Case Study | May–Aug 2025

Project Detail	Confirmed Information
Client	The GlamSquad Salon
Engagement	Direct client engagement
Role	Business Analyst + Data Analyst
Primary Stakeholder	Salon manager
Project Period	May–Aug 2025
Historical Data	Approximately one year
Primary Sources	Excel and handwritten operational records
Tools	Excel, Google Sheets, SQL, Python and Power BI
Outcome	15% profit increase within approximately two months following implementation of necessary recommendations
Document purpose: Define the business context, problem, project objectives, analytical scope, approach, outcome and evidence boundaries for the GlamSquad Salon case study.	

1. Executive Overview

The GlamSquad Salon engagement was initiated to diagnose declining profitability and identify practical commercial and operational changes that management could implement. The business had operational information available, but the information was spread across Excel files and handwritten records and was not analysis-ready.

Working directly with the salon manager in a combined Business Analyst and Data Analyst capacity, the engagement consolidated and analyzed approximately one year of business data. The analysis examined profitability through multiple drivers rather than treating it as a single financial metric.

Core project story: Declining profitability → understand the business → consolidate and clean data → define KPIs → analyze revenue, costs, customers, appointments, staffing, pricing and feedback → identify root causes → recommend changes → implement necessary actions → monitor outcome.

2. Business Context

Salon profitability depends on the interaction of customer demand, service pricing, service mix, staff availability, staff productivity, commissions, material costs, discounts, appointment utilization, cancellations/no-shows and customer experience. A problem in one area can affect several others. For example, inadequate peak-period staffing can constrain appointments, while underutilized staffing at other times can increase operating cost without generating proportional revenue.

The GlamSquad Salon therefore required a diagnostic view of the business: not only what was happening to profit, but which underlying operational and commercial factors were contributing to the decline.

3. Business Problem

Primary problem statement: The salon was experiencing declining profitability and management needed a data-supported explanation of the contributing factors and actionable recommendations to improve business performance.

The investigation covered the following confirmed problem areas:

- Service pricing and service mix.
- Discount behaviour and its effect on commercial performance.
- Staff salaries, commissions, utilization and scheduling.
- Appointment utilization and peak-demand periods.
- Cancellations and no-shows, which were a meaningful business problem.
- Repeat-customer behaviour and customer retention.
- Revenue performance by service and by stylist.
- Product/material costs and operating expenses.
- Customer feedback relating to pricing, staff behaviour, cleanliness and staff availability.

4. Project Objectives

Objective	Business Intent
Diagnose profitability decline	Identify the revenue, cost and operational factors contributing to reduced profit.
Improve management visibility	Create a consolidated analytical view instead of relying on fragmented operational records.
Evaluate appointments	Understand utilization, cancellations/no-shows and demand patterns.
Understand customers	Measure repeat visits and retention behaviour using available customer information.
Evaluate services and pricing	Compare service performance, pricing, discounts and service-level economics.
Evaluate staff performance	Analyze stylist revenue, appointments, working hours/utilization, repeat customers and feedback where available.
Improve staffing decisions	Identify peak-period shortages, underutilization and scheduling inefficiencies.
Use customer voice	Combine qualitative feedback with structured analysis to strengthen root-cause interpretation.
Recommend actions	Translate analytical findings into pricing, staffing, scheduling, promotion, discount, service-mix, repeat-customer and cost-control recommendations.
Measure business outcome	Compare profit before and after implemented recommendations while keeping confidential values private.

5. Data Available

Approximately one year of historical information was available. Confirmed data areas included:

Data Domain	Examples Used in Analysis
Appointments / bookings	Appointments, utilization, cancellations and no-shows
Services	Services performed and service prices
Customers	Customer data, repeat visits and retention behaviour
Staff / stylists	Staff information, salaries/commissions, working hours and attendance
Costs	Product/material costs and expenses
Commercial	Revenue, discounts and pricing
Feedback	Customer feedback and reviews

The source data was not clean. Excel and handwritten records required consolidation, cleaning and validation before reliable analysis. For repeat-customer analysis, phone-number data was used to connect repeat visits.

6. Customer Feedback Sources

Qualitative context was collected or reviewed from:

- Google reviews
- Instagram comments
- WhatsApp feedback
- Surveys

- Salon records
- Direct conversations

Confirmed recurring themes included pricing, staff behaviour, cleanliness and staff availability. These sources were used as qualitative evidence alongside structured operational analysis; they were not treated as financial transaction data.

7. Analytical Scope

Analysis Area	Questions Addressed
Profitability	What revenue and expense drivers were affecting profit?
Appointments	How effectively were appointment slots being utilized?
Cancellations / no-shows	Were lost appointments contributing meaningfully to business performance?
Customers	Which customers returned, and what did repeat-visit/retention behaviour indicate?
Services	Which services contributed revenue and how did service mix affect performance?
Pricing / discounts	Were some services potentially underpriced, were discounts too high, and did premium services show stronger economics?
Staffing	Was staffing aligned with demand, working hours and appointment activity?
Stylist performance	How did revenue and other performance indicators vary across stylists?
Scheduling	Were peak-period shortages and off-peak underutilization creating inefficiency?
Feedback	Did customer comments reinforce issues observed in operational data?

8. Root-Cause Framework

The profitability problem was decomposed into revenue/customer drivers and cost/operational drivers. This prevented the analysis from assuming that a single issue, such as pricing, was responsible for the decline.

Revenue / Customer Drivers	Cost / Operational Drivers
Service mix	Salary and commission costs
Pricing	Staff underutilization
Discounts	Peak-period understaffing
Repeat customers / retention	Scheduling inefficiencies
Cancellations / no-shows	Product/material costs

9. Confirmed Operational Findings

- Insufficient staff during peak-demand periods.
- Some staff were underutilized during other periods.
- There were major differences in revenue generated by stylists.
- Salary/commission costs were an important profitability consideration.
- Scheduling problems contributed to operational inefficiency.
- Cancellations/no-shows were a meaningful business problem.
- Peak demand was generally associated with evenings and periods around major festivals.

Precision note: The exact historical peak days/hours are not retained. The portfolio therefore describes the observed evening/festival-period pattern without inventing precise time slots or percentages.

10. Profitability & Commercial Logic

At the overall business level, profitability was interpreted using the standard relationship:

Profit formula: Profit = Revenue – Expenses

Where sufficient service-level cost information was available, service economics could also be examined by comparing service revenue with associated direct costs such as materials and relevant commission/cost components.

Service-level analytical concept: Service Contribution / Margin = Service Revenue – Direct Service Costs

The portfolio does not publish the salon's confidential revenue, expense, profit, margin, pricing or discount values.

11. Recommendations

Recommendations addressed the confirmed profitability drivers across:

- Pricing changes.
- Staffing adjustments.
- Improved staff scheduling.
- Promotions.
- Reduced / better-controlled discounts.
- Service-mix optimization.
- Repeat-customer initiatives.
- Cost reduction.

The intention was to improve profitability through coordinated commercial and operational changes rather than optimize a single KPI in isolation.

12. Solution & Deliverables

The engagement used Excel, Google Sheets, SQL and Python for data preparation and analysis, and Power BI for management reporting. A Power BI dashboard was built from scratch and the final analysis and recommendations were presented to the salon manager through a live walkthrough.

Deliverable / Output	Purpose
Cleaned analytical dataset	Create a reliable base from fragmented operational records.
Profitability and root-cause analysis	Identify contributing revenue, cost and operational factors.
Customer / appointment analysis	Understand repeat visits, utilization, retention and no-shows.
Staff / stylist analysis	Assess performance, utilization, staffing alignment and scheduling.
Service / pricing analysis	Evaluate service performance, pricing, discounts and economics.
Power BI dashboard	Provide management with consolidated analytical visibility.
Recommendations	Convert findings into actionable business changes.
Live walkthrough	Explain findings, dashboard interpretation and recommended actions to management.

13. Business Outcome

Following implementation of the necessary recommendations, the salon recorded a 15% increase in profit within approximately two months.

Impact calculation: Profit Improvement % = $(\text{Profit After Recommendations} - \text{Profit Before Recommendations}) \div \text{Profit Before Recommendations} \times 100$

The underlying before-and-after financial values remain confidential and are not included in this portfolio.

14. Evidence Boundaries & Confidentiality

To keep the case study accurate and defensible, the following boundaries apply:

- No client-level customer records or personally identifiable information are disclosed.
- No confidential revenue, expense, salary, commission, pricing, margin or profit values are published.
- No customer count, appointment count, staff count or transaction volume is invented.
- No exact peak hour/day is claimed because it is not retained.
- No unsupported discount percentage, service margin or causal contribution percentage is stated.
- Any future sanitized dashboard examples must be clearly identified as portfolio reconstructions rather than original client data.